First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Fall Series 8
Sacred Earth, Sacred Soul ~ The Sacred Feminine
25 October 2026

COMMUNION

Preaching: ML
Worship Leading: LVF and Cynthia Siadat

Organ Prelude-Concert

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Chiming of the Hour

[Laura & Cynthia to center chancel]

Welcome **LVF**

Words of Gathering **CS & LVF**

Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn Of Gathering**

[Laura center chancel]

Prayer of Awareness **LVF**

[All turn towards choir]

Introit The Joys of Life Esme Gregoropoulos
The Cathedral Ringers, Grace Sheldon-Williams, *Conductor*

[Cynthia to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer** **CS**

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,
As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Laura center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace** **LVF**

This morning, may the peace of God be with you.
And also with you!

You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow

Please be seated

[Cynthia to lectern]

Reading from Our Religious Tradition ***from the Wisdom of Sirach*** **CS**

This is the witness of the ancients…
Thanks be to God!

[Christoph transition Laura to center chancel]

Prayers with the People **LVF**

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

Silence

[2 minutes of silence, then Christoph transition out of silence]

Prayer of Our Hearts

[Christoph transition for Laude]

Meditation Anthem The Gnomic Verses of Saint Kassía
Text and Music:Kassía (9th century)
Arranged by Ianthe Marini
Ianthe Marini, Tiffany Ho, Molly Pease, Rachel Steinke, *Quartet,* Dr. Christoph Bull, *Drone*
Wealth without friends is a dark dwelling place! I've no respect for a judge who shows favoritism to status and takes orders from influential individuals. Wealth covers sin. The poor are left naked. The greedy hoarder of wealth lives in poverty in the midst of wealth; they possess all things except those they do not know how to use.

[Christoph transition Michael to pulpit]

Sermon ***The Sacred Feminine*** **ML**

[Christoph transition as Michael & Laura go behind communion table]

The Eucharist and Blessings **LVF & ML**

Words of Invitation and Remembrance

You are welcome at this table if you have a little faith, a lot of faith, absolutely no faith, or are of another faith. This is the Table of the Christ, and the welcome is wide!

Sharing of the Bread and the Cup
At this table we celebrate all the diverse ways we have been created. Everyone is invited to share in this feast. This morning we will receive communion with gluten free wafers and grape juice. You are invited to come forward to receive these gifts and then light a candle to signify the prayers of your heart on this day. As we share this time, we remember that this is the bread of new life and the cup of hope, given in love for each of us.

[Cynthia to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity **CS**

You will find information for online giving in your programs and appearing on your screens at home. Our Hospitality Team will also come forward now to receive your offerings. Thank you for your ongoing generosity through the resources, time, and talents you bring to strengthen our community to be the Love of the Divine in the world.

Offertory Vuelie Fjellheim & Beck
Indigenous Sápmi

Cathedral Choir, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Conductor*
Wonderful is the Earth

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**
From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!
Alleluia! Alleluia!

Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.
Alleluia! Alleluia!
Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!
[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[Cynthia to lectern]

***Prayer of Offering** **CS**

Please be seated

[Michael and Laura center chancel]

Life at First Church **LVF & ML**

Words of Blessing **ML**

Choral Response The Song of Brigid Laura Ash
Cathedral Choir, Dr. Ianthe Marini, *Conductor*

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Laura center chancel]

Postlude

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Inside The Music - Dr. Ianthe Marini